beniFIT Product Brief

beniFIT connects to your health insurance, reads your coverage and every bill, and its helper Beni tells you in plain words what you're owed before you lose it.

The problem

People pay for health benefits they never use, and pay medical bills they don't actually owe. Nobody tells them at the moment it matters.

- **Benefits are buried.** A typical employer guide runs 20 to 40 pages of fine print across dozens of vendors. Free rides to appointments, $75 wellness claims, free counseling and expiring FSA money sit in footnotes and legal notices.
- **Bills are confusing.** A hospital bill, the insurance EOB and the itemized bill rarely match. Most people pay the bill without checking it.
- **Money expires quietly.** FSA balances, wellness rewards and claim deadlines run out with no reminder.
- **The people hurt most** are families with tight budgets, older adults and immigrants who are new to the US insurance system.
- **Help only comes after something goes wrong.** Existing tools step in once a bill is disputed or a claim is denied.

What beniFIT is

beniFIT is a personal benefits assistant that lives in your planner. You connect your health insurance once. Beni reads your coverage, your claims and your benefits guide, then speaks up before an appointment, when money is about to expire, and when a bill doesn't look right.

Name: beniFIT, your benefits, finally fitting your life.

Tagline: Know what you're owed, before, during and after.

Meet Beni

Beni is a small, warm helper who sits in your planner and only speaks up when it matters.

Trait	What it means
Friendly	Talks like a friend: "Hey Maria, heads up…" instead of insurance language
Plain	Explains everything in simple words, with the dollar amount up front
Proactive	Comes to you inside your day, so you never need to remember to check
On your side	Works only for you, never for the insurer or the employer

Trait	What it means
Careful	Says "you may be eligible" and shows where the rule comes from

Every message from Beni ends with one clear button: **Call**, **Open app**, **Claim it** or **Draft dispute**.

How it works

Beni combines three sources. Each one covers something the others can't see.

Source	How Beni gets it	What it tells Beni
Health insurance	The member connects their plan through the insurer's Patient Access API (FHIR standard, with the member's permission)	Plan, member ID, coverage dates, every claim and EOB: what was billed, allowed, paid and owed
Benefits guide	The member uploads their plan guide or employer booklet, and Gemini reads it	Hidden perks, free programs, wellness claims, FSA rules, deadlines, vendor phone numbers and apps
Planner	The member adds plans as usual: "Dentist next month," "Find a gym"	When each benefit matters, so Beni can speak up at the right moment

Why both insurance and the guide: the insurance connection shows real claims and costs, but it doesn't know about employer perks like counseling, gym discounts, supplemental insurance or FSA money. Those only live in the benefits guide.

What the connection covers today: a federal CMS rule requires Medicare Advantage, Medicaid, CHIP and healthcare.gov plans to offer this access. Some large commercial insurers are reachable through aggregators like Flexpa. Most employer plans aren't required to offer it yet, so for them Beni reads the uploaded guide and bills.

The flow

1. Connect insurance (one login) and upload the benefits guide
2. Beni builds a profile: plan, costs, every benefit, every deadline
3. Beni shows a first summary: "You have 6 benefits you've never used, worth about $1,100"
4. As you plan your days, Beni matches each plan to a benefit
5. When a claim or bill arrives, Beni checks it against the EOB and the plan rules
6. Beni alerts you with one action to take

Features and Beni's examples

Beni follows you before care, while you plan, and after the bill. Amounts below are demo examples from the fictional Brightway plan.

Before you go

You plan	Beni says	Button
"MRI Tuesday at City Imaging"	"City Imaging is in-network. Expected cost is about $180. Ask if the radiologist is in-network too, and whether you need prior approval."	Call ClearPath
"Annual checkup"	"Your checkup is free. If you bring up a new problem, they may bill a separate visit, so ask first."	Add questions
"See a dermatologist"	"You don't need a referral. The 4.5-star doctor nearby has a $45 copay instead of $130."	Compare doctors
"Knee surgery consult"	"Before surgery, you can get a free expert second opinion through SecondLook."	Call SecondLook

While you plan (hidden benefits)

You plan	Beni found	Button
"Book Uber to the hospital Tuesday"	"Your plan covers up to 12 free rides a year to appointments. Book 48 hours ahead."	Book a ride
"Eat healthier, find a gym"	"Free dietitian visits, plus a gym network from $10 a month."	Book dietitian
"Stressed about Mom"	"5 free counseling sessions, and backup elder care at $6 an hour."	Call Talk Line
"Knee hurts after running"	"Free virtual physical therapy, with equipment shipped home."	Open MoveWell
"Take a data course"	"Up to $5,250 a year in tuition help. Get approval before the course starts."	Open LearnUp
"Trying to quit vaping"	"Finish 5 free coaching sessions and get back the $40 per paycheck surcharge."	Call Quit Kit

Alerts

Alert	Beni says
Expiring money	"$420 left in your FSA expires Dec 31. Glasses, sunscreen and first aid kits count."
Claim deadline	"Submit your 2027 FSA receipts by March 31."
Money waiting	"Your checkup qualifies for three $75 wellness claims. Want me to start them?"

Alert	Beni says
Rewards	"You're 2 steps from $420 in wellness rewards. Deadline Dec 15."
Enrollment	"Enrollment closes Nov 30. If you don't choose, you'll have no medical coverage next year."
Life event	"New baby? You have 30 days to add her to your plan."

After the bill

What arrives	Beni says	Button
Hospital bill for $480	"Your insurance says you owe $180. That's $300 too much."	Draft dispute
Bill before the EOB	"Insurance hasn't processed this yet. Don't pay until it does."	Remind me
Out-of-network lab at an in-network hospital	"This is likely protected under the No Surprises Act. You should only pay your in-network cost."	Draft dispute
Denied claim	"You have 180 days to appeal. I drafted a letter, and your doctor can add a note."	Review letter
Duplicate charge	"The same blood test is listed twice. Ask for an itemized bill."	Request itemized bill

Reading a bill

The rule Beni follows: never pay more than the "you owe" amount on the insurance EOB.

The three documents

Document	Who sends it	What it says
Bill	Doctor or hospital	"You owe $480." Often vague, no detail
EOB (Explanation of Benefits)	Insurance	What was billed, what the plan allowed, what it paid, what you really owe. It is not a bill
Itemized bill	Doctor or hospital, only when you ask	Every code and charge, line by line

Example: Maria's MRI

Line	Amount	What it means
Billed by hospital	$2,400	List price, ignore it
Allowed by plan	$900	Negotiated price
Plan paid	$720	Insurance share (80%)
Maria owes per EOB	$180	Her real share (20%)
Hospital bill says	$480	$300 too much

Errors Beni checks for

1. The bill is higher than the "you owe" amount on the EOB
2. The same charge appears twice
3. A service that never happened
4. An out-of-network lab, anesthesiologist or radiologist at an in-network hospital
5. A free preventive visit billed as a paid office visit
6. A bill sent before insurance processed the claim
7. The deductible applied twice, or charges after the out-of-pocket maximum was reached
8. A denied claim that may be worth appealing

Demo story: Maria

One person and one week, about 3 minutes on stage. All data is fake.

Maria, 38, works at Brightway (fictional), is on the ClearPath PPO plan, has a Health Care FSA and Accident, Critical Illness and Hospital insurance, and takes care of her mom. She has never read her benefits guide.

Step	On screen	Beni says
1. Connect	Maria taps "Connect my insurance" and uploads the Brightway guide	"Got it! I read your plan and your 16-page guide."
2. First summary	A list of unused benefits with a running total	"You have 6 benefits you've never used, worth about $1,100 this year."
3. Plan the week	Maria types "MRI Tuesday, book Uber to the hospital"	"City Imaging is in-network, about $180. And your plan covers free rides to appointments. Book one?"
4. Life plan	Maria types "Stressed about Mom, maybe find a gym"	"5 free counseling sessions, backup elder care at $6 an hour, and gyms from $10 a month."
5. Alert	A countdown badge	"$420 left in your FSA expires Dec 31."

Step	On screen	Beni says
6. The bill	Maria uploads a $480 hospital bill	"Your insurance says you owe $180. That's $300 too much. I drafted a message to the billing office."
7. Close	Total on screen	"This year, Beni found Maria $1,400."

Line to say on stage

> *"Maria didn't ask about benefits. She just planned her week. Beni found $1,400 she was already paying for, or about to overpay."*

Who else does this

Parts of this exist, which shows the problem is real. No one we found puts benefits and bills together inside a person's day.

Who	What they do	Who pays	What's missing
Sheer Health	Consumer app. You connect your insurance; it explains bills, reviews claims for errors and handles disputes. Says it has recovered about $7M for members	Free app, members pay for dispute help	Acts only after the bill. Doesn't know employer perks or your plans
Nayya	AI benefits guide for employees: enrollment help, preventive care nudges, unclaimed supplemental insurance payouts	Employers	Only exists if your employer buys it. Doesn't check bills
AI appeal letter tools	Draft letters to fight denied claims (CHLPI)	Varies	One task, only after a denial

How beniFIT is different

1. **It lives in your day.** It's a planner, so you never have to remember to open it.
2. **Before, during and after.** Others cover one moment; Beni covers all three.
3. **Everything in one place.** Insurance claims plus employer perks, FSA and supplemental insurance.
4. **It works for you.** It's independent from the insurer, so its only job is getting people their money.

Pitch

One-liner: Beni connects to your health insurance and tells you what you're owed, before you lose it.

30 seconds

> *"We pay for benefits we never use and bills we shouldn't owe. Meet Beni from beniFIT. Connect your insurance once, and Beni reads your coverage and every bill, alerts you*

> *before money expires, and catches billing mistakes before you pay. Beni makes your benefits fit your life."*

60 seconds

> *"Raise your hand if you've read your whole benefits guide. Ours is 16 pages of fine print, and it hides free rides to the doctor, free counseling, wellness cash and FSA money that disappears on December 31. Then the bills come, and the hospital bill doesn't match what insurance says you owe.*
>
> *Meet Beni from beniFIT. You connect your health insurance once and upload your benefits guide. Beni lives in your planner. When you plan an MRI, Beni tells you it's covered, what it should cost and that you can get a free ride there. When the bill arrives, Beni checks it against your insurance and catches a $300 mistake. In one week, Beni found Maria $1,400.*
>
> *Other tools wait for something to go wrong. Beni shows up in your plans, before the money is lost. Know what you're owed, before, during and after."*

Judge questions

Question	Answer
Isn't this Sheer Health?	Sheer fixes bills after they go wrong. Beni lives in your planner, prevents the loss and finds money you didn't know you had.
How do you get the data?	Insurers covered by the CMS rule must offer a patient access API with the member's permission. For other plans, Beni reads the uploaded guide and bills.
What about privacy?	The member chooses what to connect and can disconnect any time. We never sell data. The demo uses fake data only.
What if Beni is wrong?	Beni says "may be eligible," shows the exact page or rule it used, and links to the vendor to confirm.
Who pays?	Free for people, with paid help for disputes. Later, employers and nonprofits can offer it to their people.
Why now?	Insurance data is finally open by law, and AI can finally read 40-page guides and messy bills.

Trust and privacy

Health and money data is personal, so trust is part of the product.

- **Opt-in only.** The member chooses what to connect and can disconnect or delete everything at any time.
- **No selling data.** beniFIT never sells or shares data with insurers, employers or advertisers.

- **Careful wording.** Beni says "you may be eligible" and never promises coverage.
- **Shows its source.** Every alert links to the page of the guide or the claim it came from.
- **Human in control.** Beni drafts disputes and claims; the member reviews and sends them.
- **Built for HIPAA-level security** before handling real member data.
- **Demo uses fake data only.** Brightway, Maria and every number and phone number are fictional.

Hackathon build plan

Goal for today: one working story (Maria) that a judge can follow in 3 minutes.

Scope

Must have	Nice to have	Skip today
"Connect insurance" screen (sandbox login or sample data)	Live CMS Blue Button sandbox login	Real member data
Benefits guide upload, read by Gemini	Beni avatar animation	Full calendar sync
Unused benefits summary with total $	Voice for Beni	Every insurer
Planner input that triggers 3 matches	Drafted claim forms	Payments
One alert (FSA expiring)	Push notifications	
Bill upload with one error caught and dispute drafted		

Tech

- **AI:** Gemini reads the benefits guide PDF, the claims data and the bill, and writes Beni's messages
- **Insurance data:** CMS Blue Button sandbox with synthetic Medicare members (OAuth 2.0, FHIR format). Backup: sample FHIR files in the same format
- **Benefits source:** Brightway 2027 Benefits Guide (16-page fictional booklet) plus the clean summary version
- **Front end:** simple web app with a planner view, Beni's alert cards and action buttons

Demo data we have or need

- ☒ Fictional company Brightway and its 16-page benefits booklet
- ☒ Clean Brightway 2027 Benefits Guide (the concise version)
- ☐ Maria's profile: plan, FSA balance, insurance elections
- ☐ Maria's claims and EOBs in FHIR format, including the MRI
- ☐ Hospital bill for $480 with the $300 error
- ☐ Beni character image

Team roles

Role	Owns
Product and pitch	Story, Beni's voice, slides, presenting
AI	Gemini prompts for reading the guide, matching plans, checking bills
Front end	Planner screen, alerts, buttons
Data	Sample insurance data, bill and Maria's profile

After the hackathon

Roadmap

1. **Prove it:** 20 to 50 real people upload their guide and bills; measure dollars found per person
2. **Connect:** live insurance connections for Medicare Advantage, Medicaid and marketplace plans, then commercial insurers through an aggregator
3. **Act for you:** Beni files wellness claims, FSA claims and disputes with one tap
4. **Grow:** offer beniFIT through employers, unions, nonprofits and community health groups that serve families most likely to miss benefits

Business model options

Model	How it works
Free for people	Core alerts and bill checks are free
Success fee	A small share of money recovered from disputes, only when Beni wins
Premium	Hands-on help with appeals and claims for a monthly fee
Employers and nonprofits	Pay per member to offer Beni to their people

Success metrics

- Dollars found and recovered per member
- Share of alerts acted on
- Billing errors caught before payment
- Benefits used for the first time

Sources

- CMS Interoperability and Prior Authorization Final Rule fact sheet
- CMS Blue Button 2.0 API documentation
- Flexpa FAQ: covered payers and data
- theSkimm: Sheer Health
- Nayya for Employers

- CHLPI: AI vs. AI, patients deploy bots to battle insurers